

Threat Intelligence: Sources, Analysis & Action

What Threat Intelligence Is

Not "a list of bad IPs" â€” but **processed, filtered, relevant** information about threats that *your* org can act on. Intelligence = (data + context + analysis) at the moment it helps *you*.

The Intelligence Cycle

Requirements â†’ Collection â†’ Processing â†’ Analysis â†’ Dissemination â†’ Feedback

Start from **requirements** (the questions your leadership asks: "will our sector be targeted?") or the cycle spins without purpose.

The Harm Triangle (the why-behind-the-bad)

What does the adversary want from *your* organization?

Theft (data, money, IP)
Disruption (availability, extortion)
Deception (prestige, influence)

Organizations rank these differently â€” that ranking IS the intelligence priority list.

Sources: Open, Feeds, Targeted

Open-source (OSINT) â€” M10: vendor blogs, advisories, dark-web chatter research, public reporting

Feeds â€” MISP/OpenCTI eventstreams, abuse.ch, VirusTotal, **CISA KEV** (M15)

Targeted/commercial â€” monitoring of adversary infrastructure you're exposed to

MITRE ATT&CK: The Shared Language

The matrix of **tactics** (goals) and **techniques** (methods):

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Initial Access (T1566 Phishing)
  â†’ Execution (T1059 PowerShell)
  â†’ Persistence (T1547 Startup Folder)
  â†’ Defense Evasion (T1562 Impair Defenses)
  â†’ Credential Access (T1003 Dump LSASS)
  â†’ Collection & Exfiltration (T1041)
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Why it matters: you can map your detections to techniques, gaps become visible, and you can say "we have an ATP gap at collection."

Intelligence Led the Blue Team

Detection â€” new KEV CVE â†’ write the Sigma rule NOW (before the smoke)

Hunting â€” intelligence says sector targeted â†’ hunt for those TTPs in your logs

Response â€” incident: check intel for the IOCs/countermeasures

Process â€” block new C2 domains from virus feeds automatically

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# example: jam a feed into your firewall/EDR (education)
# curl the MISP/abuse.ch CSV to a blocklist - the 'dissemination' phase
curl -s https://feed.example/targeted-iocs.csv -o iocs.csv
python3 - <<'PY'
import csv
bad = [r[0] for r in csv.reader(open('iocs.csv')) if r] # IPs
print("pushed", len(bad), "new indicators to deny list")
PY
```

The IOCs vs TTPs Distinction (the mule trap)

IOC â€” specific artifacts (a hash, an IP) = Tom's fingerprints on a window: fast to find, quickly changed by the adversary

TTP â€” *behavior* (how the adversary works) = Tom's *steal intention*: slower to find, harder to change

Starving on IOCs: modern attackers rotate domains like socks. Behavior (TTP) detection is what survives.

Producing Intelligence

Define your ADDRESSABLE requirement ("is our fintech API being targeted?")

Answer with evidence + confidence (confirmed/suspected/unconfirmed â€" language of M14)

Timely â€" Tuesday intel for Friday's attack = intel $\Rightarrow$ Echo chamber check: bad intel (stale, vague) drowns good eats away nobody's time. Quality over volume, always.

The single most useful habit: maintain a real ATT&CK mapping table of (technique â†' do we detect? â†' evidence). That's what an "intel-driven SOC" actually runs on.

[← Security Architecture & Zero...](#)

Module complete ✓